PEER REVIEW HISTORY

BMJ Open publishes all reviews undertaken for accepted manuscripts. Reviewers are asked to complete a checklist review form (**http://bmjopen.bmj.com/site/about/resources/checklist.pdf**) and are provided with free text boxes to elaborate on their assessment. These free text comments are reproduced below.

ARTICLE DETAILS

TITLE (PROVISIONAL)	A systematic review protocol to explore goal planning in mental health service delivery
AUTHORS	Stewart, Victoria; McMillan, Sara; Roennfeldt, Helena; El-Den, Sarira; Ng, Ricki; Wheeler, Amanda

VERSION 1 – REVIEW

REVIEWER	Ben Hannigan School of Healthcare Sciences, Cardiff University
REVIEW RETURNED	07-Jan-2021

GENERAL COMMENTS	This is a protocol for a systematic review in the area of goal planning for people living with mental health difficulties. The protocol is very well-written, and looks to have all the necessary ingredients: background, questions, processes for searching, screening, data extracting, appraising and synthesising. I also see the PRISMA checklist, which is completed as far as it can be at this stage, along with the plan of registering with PROSPERO. It is good, too, to see the team includes a lived experiences researcher. I think an expectation for BMJ Open protocols is the inclusion of dates for the work which is to be done. This should probably be included, along with the dates from when databases will be searched. Personally I also found the description of how materials will be synthesised a little opaque: but I appreciate that this will be rendered clearer when findings are eventually reported.

REVIEWER	Michael Coffey Swansea University, UK
REVIEW RETURNED	07-Jan-2021

GENERAL COMMENTS	This is an interesting systematic review protocol in an area of growing research interest. I think it perhaps overstates the reference to goal planning in mental health recovery literature and you may find it difficult to locate the studies you are interested in with your limited search terms. I note with interest that you see an overlap with shared decision making but don't include this as a search term and I think this is an error that you might want to quickly reconsider. Care planning is also likely to feature as a form of goal planning and there is likely to be useful data on risk, safety, crisis and contingency planning too that relates to your area of interest. Indeed your eligibility criteria say 'any type of goal planning' but your search terms are needlessly inflexible to help you get the studies that will help you. With a small change you could locate a more relevant and interesting range of mental health services literature and produce a very useful review that I will look forward to reading when published.

VERSION 1 – AUTHOR RESPONSE

Reviewer 1 comments

1. inclusion of dates for the work which is to be done

Search dates have been added as outlined above (see response to Editor Comment 3). The following text has been added to data synthesis on Page 9 to indicate planned completion of the review (The literature review and synthesis will be completed in 2021.)

2. dates from when databases will be searched

There will be no date restrictions for study publication and have changed our terminology to study/literature publication on Page 7 to clarify this.

3. Personally I also found the description of how materials will be synthesised a little opaque: but I appreciate that this will be rendered clearer when findings are eventually reported.

We agree that the synthesis process is not clearly outlined at this stage and will be dependent on the types of literature identified in the search.

Reviewer 2 comments

1. Limited search terms particularly in regard to shared decision making, care planning, risk, safety, crisis and contingency planning.

Thank you for this comment. After consultation with the academic librarian the search terms have been changed to include shared decision making and care planning (see table below). Database searching terms such as risk, safety, crisis and contingency planning did not result in additional relevant literature.

In addition, a clearer definition of goal planning has been included on Page 6 to further focus the search and subsequent data synthesis: For the purpose of the review, the definition of a rehabilitation goal by Siegert and Levack will be applied i.e. “Rehabilitation goals are actively selected, intentionally created, have purpose and are shared (where possible) by the people participating in the activities and interventions designed to address the consequence of acquired disability” with goal planning defined as “the establishment or negotiation of rehabilitation goals”.(8 p11)

PICO	**Search Terms**
P	“mental disorder”[MeSH] OR “mental health”[MeSH] OR “mental illness*” OR “mental health*” OR “mental disorder*” OR “mental health condition*” OR “mental health diagnosis” OR “psychiatric illness*” OR “psychiatric disorder*” OR “psychiatric condition*” OR “psychiatric diagnosis” OR “mental health consumer*” OR “mental health service user*” NOT child* OR youth* OR adolescent*

I	AND AND ("Goals" [MeSH] OR Goal*) OR ("Patient Care Planning"[MeSH] OR (Care AND plan*)) OR ("Decision making, shared"[MeSH] OR "shared decision mak*") AND (set* OR plan* OR attain* OR achieve* OR assess* OR orient* OR commit* OR "action plan" OR "recovery plan") Note: search terms will be modified to suit individual databases e.g., Emtree or Subject Headings
O	No search limitations imposed.

Thank you for considering this revised manuscript for publication.

I would also like to draw your attention to my original submission regarding my request for a fee waiver for this manuscript, as I am a self-funded PhD student. I can confirm that I am not receiving any funding for my research and have attached a letter of support from my Head of School detailing my financial position.

Kind regards, on behalf of the authors.

Victoria Stewart

VERSION 2 – REVIEW

REVIEWER	Michael Coffey Swansea University, Wales, UK
REVIEW RETURNED	09-Mar-2021

GENERAL COMMENTS	Thank you for attending to my suggested revisions. I wish success with your review and look forward to seeing the results published in due course.